

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/13: 1. Control question, conceptual grammar and language control

NOTIONS OF GOD (Paper 11, Section B, Item 1)

SYLLABUS, VERBATIM: "Notions of God : Attributes; Relation to Man and the World.
(Indian and Western)."

|
v

CONTROL QUESTION: what kind of reality is called "God", which predicates may be used of it,
and how is it related to the world and to human beings?

|
+-- LAYER 1 DEFINITION what controls correct use of the word "God"?
+-- LAYER 2 REFERENCE what reality, if any, is denoted?
+-- LAYER 3 ATTRIBUTE which perfections are affirmed, and are they compossible?
+-- LAYER 4 MODEL person | substance | pure act | ground | process | absolute
+-- LAYER 5 RELIGIOUS FORM .. what follows for worship, prayer, morality, liberation?

|
TWO INDEPENDENT AXES (do not merge them)
NATURE AXIS : personal <----> transpersonal <----> impersonal
RELATION AXIS : transcendent (ontological independence) <----> immanent (sustaining presence)

|
LANGUAGE CONTROL
cataphatic (affirming: good, wise, loving) + apophatic (denying creaturely mode)
-> analogical predication keeps real reference without univocal transfer
too much affirmation = anthropomorphism | too much negation = empty God-talk

|
FIREWALL: Topic 01 owns the CONTENT and COHERENCE of the God-concept.
existence arguments -> Topic 02 Proofs | suffering -> Topic 03 Evil
liberation -> Topic 04 Soul | experience -> Topic 06 | semantics -> Topic 10 Language

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/13: 2. Western classification grid – count, structure and worship

COUNTING CLAIMS

STRUCTURAL CLAIMS

MONOTHEISM	one supreme God	CLASSICAL THEISM	one necessary perfect God who
POLYTHEISM	several genuine deities		creates, sustains, governs, and is
HENOTHEISM	the invoked deity addressed as supreme, others not denied	DEISM	transcendent AND immanent creator + natural order, then
KATHENOTHEISM	"one-god-at-a-time" (F. Max Muller's terms for the Rgvedic pattern)	PANTHEISM	withdrawal; no continuing revelation God and all-inclusive reality are one
MONOLATRY	worship of one, others may exist	PANENTHEISM	world is IN God, God exceeds world

|
CRITICAL CONTROL: monotheism is only the COUNTING claim.

Classical theism adds necessity, creation + conservation, perfect goodness,
eternity, immutability, simplicity, personhood. One-God belief supplies none of these.

|
SIX ROLE-PROFILES (not synonyms; each carries its own pressure)

CREATOR	 all creaturely being depends on God	pressure: free or necessary creation?
SUSTAINER	 dependence continues every moment	pressure: timeless yet continuous act
RULER	 history and nature governed	pressure: freedom, contingency, hiddenness
MORAL GOVERNOR	action answerable to divine justice	pressure: autonomy and suffering
GROUND OF BEING	non-dependent source of actuality (Tillich's "being-itself" = REVISIONARY profile, not a proof)	pressure: personality, addressability
ABSOLUTE	 self-sufficient, non-relative	pressure: may stop resembling a person

|
CREATION FROM NOTHING (creatio ex nihilo) != MANUFACTURE

no independent material co-principle; "nothing" is not a stuff

dependence is CONTINUOUS, not a first event

primary cause (God) does not compete with secondary natural causes

CONTRAST: Nyaya keeps eternal atoms as material cause; Spinoza has no creative act;

Advaita has vivarta; Ramanuja has real parinama of cit-acit.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/13: 3. The attribute package – exact notion, pressure, controlled reply

|

OMNIPOTENCE power over every ABSOLUTELY POSSIBLE state of affairs
pressure: stone paradox; "cannot sin or lie"
reply: contradictions name no possible object (Aquinas, ST I q.25 a.3);
impeccability is perfection of power, not deficiency

OMNISCIENCE knowledge of every truth
pressure: future free acts; tensed and indexical knowledge
reply: timeless knowledge | soft facts | middle knowledge | revised future truth

PERFECT GOODNESS unsurpassable moral perfection
pressure: evil; is goodness independent of divine will?
reply: goodness belongs necessarily to divine nature (full theodicy -> Topic 03)

ETERNITY timeless possession of life OR everlasting existence through all time
pressure: acting "before/after"; responsiveness
reply: one timeless act grounds temporal effects; contingency remains pressured

IMMUTABILITY / IMPASSIBILITY no intrinsic change; not acted upon
pressure: knowledge, love and response look personal only if relationally changing
reply: distinguish intrinsic change from NEW RELATIONS and effects (contested)

SIMPLICITY no composition: matter/form, substance/accident, essence/existence
pressure: modal collapse; property-vs-person objection
reply: analogical identity or truthmaker reading, each with a cost

ASEITY exists from itself, derives nothing NECESSITY cannot fail to exist

PERSONHOOD intelligence, will, knowledge, love, addressability WITHOUT body or sex
pressure: anthropomorphism and gender projection
reply: personal predicates are analogical, never univocally human

|

TIMELESS-ACTION DILEMMA: one timeless act can ground a temporal order, yet if no alternative divine act is possible the contingency of creation is threatened.

IMMUTABILITY VERDICT: constancy of character need not mean inertness, but removing every real relation preserves metaphysics by weakening religious personality.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/13: 4. Two paradoxes, four named exits, Indian parity (2020 Q5(d))

PARADOX OF THE STONE / MACKIE'S PARADOX OF OMNIPOTENCE

- (1) an omnipotent being can create any object it chooses
- (2) it can create a thing it cannot afterwards control
- (3) either it cannot create such a thing, or it cannot control it
- (4) either way something is beyond its power

REPLY: Aquinas restricts power to the absolutely possible (ST I q.25 a.3)

MACKIE'S SHARPER FORM: first-order power (over things) vs second-order power
(to fix what powers exist) cannot both be unrestricted

OUTLIER: Descartes' universal possibilism – even the eternal truths depend on divine will
(coherent, but logic becomes contingent)

|

FOREKNOWLEDGE DILEMMA

- (1) God infallibly believed at t1 that S will do A at t2
- (2) the past is now fixed (accidental necessity)
- (3) an infallible belief cannot be false
- (4) so at t2 S cannot refrain from A
- (5) so S does not act freely in the libertarian sense

|

FOUR EXITS – name the premise each one denies, and pay its price

BOETHIAN / THOMIST ETERNITY timeless nunc stans; there is no *fore*knowledge
denies (2)'s application | cost: responsiveness and the entailment remain

OCKHAMISM "God believed at t1..." is a SOFT FACT, partly about the future
denies (2) | cost: hard/soft must be specified non-circularly

MOLINISM (Luis de Molina, Concordia) MIDDLE KNOWLEDGE (scientia media) of
counterfactuals of freedom, prior to the creative decree
denies the entailment | cost: the GROUNDING OBJECTION

OPEN THEISM future free acts are not yet truths; omniscience = knowledge of all truths
denies (3)'s scope | cost: revises the classical attribute the question presupposes

|

INDIAN PARITY

NYAYA: Isvara is karmadhyaksa, allotting fruits ACCORDING TO adrsta -> effort (purusakara)
is preserved against fate (daiva); God administers, does not choose for the agent

GITA 18.61 (Lord in the heart-region, turning beings as if mounted on a machine, yantra)
held together with 18.63 (yatheccchasi tatha kuru – "act as you wish"): the canonical
Indian CRUX, not a solved proof

ADVAITA dissolves the problem: agency belongs to the jiva under limiting adjuncts (upadhis)

RAMANUJA: divine consent (anumati) sustains the capacity to act; authorship stays with the jiva

|

VERDICT FORMULA: compatible only on a specified reading of each term – say which premise you deny.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/13: 5. Simplicity, aseity and the Indian parity bench

DIVINE SIMPLICITY (DDS) – Aquinas ST 1 q1 q2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50, 51, 52, 53, 54, 55, 56, 57, 58, 59, 60, 61, 62, 63, 64, 65, 66, 67, 68, 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, 74, 75, 76, 77, 78, 79, 80, 81, 82, 83, 84, 85, 86, 87, 88, 89, 90, 91, 92, 93, 94, 95, 96, 97, 98, 99, 100, 101, 102, 103, 104, 105, 106, 107, 108, 109, 110, 111, 112, 113, 114, 115, 116, 117, 118, 119, 120, 121, 122, 123, 124, 125, 126, 127, 128, 129, 130, 131, 132, 133, 134, 135, 136, 137, 138, 139, 140, 141, 142, 143, 144, 145, 146, 147, 148, 149, 150, 151, 152, 153, 154, 155, 156, 157, 158, 159, 160, 161, 162, 163, 164, 165, 166, 167, 168, 169, 170, 171, 172, 173, 174, 175, 176, 177, 178, 179, 180, 181, 182, 183, 184, 185, 186, 187, 188, 189, 190, 191, 192, 193, 194, 195, 196, 197, 198, 199, 200, 201, 202, 203, 204, 205, 206, 207, 208, 209, 210, 211, 212, 213, 214, 215, 216, 217, 218, 219, 220, 221, 222, 223, 224, 225, 226, 227, 228, 229, 230, 231, 232, 233, 234, 235, 236, 237, 238, 239, 240, 241, 242, 243, 244, 245, 246, 247, 248, 249, 250, 251, 252, 253, 254, 255, 256, 257, 258, 259, 260, 261, 262, 263, 264, 265, 266, 267, 268, 269, 270, 271, 272, 273, 274, 275, 276, 277, 278, 279, 280, 281, 282, 283, 284, 285, 286, 287, 288, 289, 290, 291, 292, 293, 294, 295, 296, 297, 298, 299, 300, 301, 302, 303, 304, 305, 306, 307, 308, 309, 310, 311, 312, 313, 314, 315, 316, 317, 318, 319, 320, 321, 322, 323, 324, 325, 326, 327, 328, 329, 330, 331, 332, 333, 334, 335, 336, 337, 338, 339, 340, 341, 342, 343, 344, 345, 346, 347, 348, 349, 350, 351, 352, 353, 354, 355, 356, 357, 358, 359, 360, 361, 362, 363, 364, 365, 366, 367, 368, 369, 370, 371, 372, 373, 374, 375, 376, 377, 378, 379, 380, 381, 382, 383, 384, 385, 386, 387, 388, 389, 390, 391, 392, 393, 394, 395, 396, 397, 398, 399, 400, 401, 402, 403, 404, 405, 406, 407, 408, 409, 410, 411, 412, 413, 414, 415, 416, 417, 418, 419, 420, 421, 422, 423, 424, 425, 426, 427, 428, 429, 430, 431, 432, 433, 434, 435, 436, 437, 438, 439, 440, 441, 442, 443, 444, 445, 446, 447, 448, 449, 450, 451, 452, 453, 454, 455, 456, 457, 458, 459, 460, 461, 462, 463, 464, 465, 466, 467, 468, 469, 470, 471, 472, 473, 474, 475, 476, 477, 478, 479, 480, 481, 482, 483, 484, 485, 486, 487, 488, 489, 490, 491, 492, 493, 494, 495, 496, 497, 498, 499, 500, 501, 502, 503, 504, 505, 506, 507, 508, 509, 510, 511, 512, 513, 514, 515, 516, 517, 518, 519, 520, 521, 522, 523, 524, 525, 526, 527, 528, 529, 530, 531, 532, 533, 534, 535, 536, 537, 538, 539, 540, 541, 542, 543, 544, 545, 546, 547, 548, 549, 550, 551, 552, 553, 554, 555, 556, 557, 558, 559, 560, 561, 562, 563, 564, 565, 566, 567, 568, 569, 570, 571, 572, 573, 574, 575, 576, 577, 578, 579, 580, 581, 582, 583, 584, 585, 586, 587, 588, 589, 590, 591, 592, 593, 594, 595, 596, 597, 598, 599, 600, 601, 602, 603, 604, 605, 606, 607, 608, 609, 610, 611, 612, 613, 614, 615, 616, 617, 618, 619, 620, 621, 622, 623, 624, 625, 626, 627, 628, 629, 630, 631, 632, 633, 634, 635, 636, 637, 638, 639, 640, 641, 642, 643, 644, 645, 646, 647, 648, 649, 650, 651, 652, 653, 654, 655, 656, 657, 658, 659, 660, 661, 662, 663, 664, 665, 666, 667, 668, 669, 670, 671, 672, 673, 674, 675, 676, 677, 678, 679, 680, 681, 682, 683, 684, 685, 686, 687, 688, 689, 690, 691, 692, 693, 694, 695, 696, 697, 698, 699, 700, 701, 702, 703, 704, 705, 706, 707, 708, 709, 710, 711, 712, 713, 714, 715, 716, 717, 718, 719, 720, 721, 722, 723, 724, 725, 726, 727, 728, 729, 730, 731, 732, 733, 734, 735, 736, 737, 738, 739, 740, 741, 742, 743, 744, 745, 746, 747, 748, 749, 750, 751, 752, 753, 754, 755, 756, 757, 758, 759, 760, 761, 762, 763, 764, 765, 766, 767, 768, 769, 770, 771, 772, 773, 774, 775, 776, 777, 778, 779, 780, 781, 782, 783, 784, 785, 786, 787, 788, 789, 790, 791, 792, 793, 794, 795, 796, 797, 798, 799, 800, 801, 802, 803, 804, 805, 806, 807, 808, 809, 810, 811, 812, 813, 814, 815, 816, 817, 818, 819, 820, 821, 822, 823, 824, 825, 826, 827, 828, 829, 830, 831, 832, 833, 834, 835, 836, 837, 838, 839, 840, 841, 842, 843, 844, 845, 846, 847, 848, 849, 850, 851, 852, 853, 854, 855, 856, 857, 858, 859, 860, 861, 862, 863, 864, 865, 866, 867, 868, 869, 870, 871, 872, 873, 874, 875, 876, 877, 878, 879, 880, 881, 882, 883, 884, 885, 886, 887, 888, 889, 890, 891, 892, 893, 894, 895, 896, 897, 898, 899, 900, 901, 902, 903, 904, 905, 906, 907, 908, 909, 910, 911, 912, 913, 914, 915, 916, 917, 918, 919, 920, 921, 922, 923, 924, 925, 926, 927, 928, 929, 930, 931, 932, 933, 934, 935, 936, 937, 938, 939, 940, 941, 942, 943, 944, 945, 946, 947, 948, 949, 950, 951, 952, 953, 954, 955, 956, 957, 958, 959, 960, 961, 962, 963, 964, 965, 966, 967, 968, 969, 970, 971, 972, 973, 974, 975, 976, 977, 978, 979, 980, 981, 982, 983, 984, 985, 986, 987, 988, 989, 990, 991, 992, 993, 994, 995, 996, 997, 998, 999, 1000

DENIES: matter/form, substance/accident, genus/difference, essence/existence distinction in God
SO: "wise", "good", "powerful" signify ONE reality under different creaturely modes of conception
ARGUMENT: (1) whatever is composite depends on parts and on their uniter
 (2) the first underived ground cannot be dependent
 (3) therefore the ultimate is non-composite
 (4) therefore the attributes are not separable components
KEEP DISTINCT: simplicity = composition | aseity = derivation
 immutability = change | impassibility = being acted upon

OBJECTIONS -> REPLIES -> RESIDUE

MODAL COLLAPSE God identical with the act of will + necessary existence => creation necessary
reply: the act is intrinsically necessary, its terminus contingent
residue: this re-imports a distinction simplicity denied
PLANTINGA (Does God Have a Nature?) if God is identical with a property, God is a property,
and no property is a person or agent
reply: read the identity analogically or as a truthmaker claim
RELIGIOUS ADEQUACY a simple, impassible God seems unable to respond, love or grieve
reply: impassibility as unwavering constancy of love – a costly revision

INDIAN PARITY (required for a full-marks 15/20)

ADVAITA: sat-cit-ananda are SVARUPA-LAKSANA (essential nature-defining marks),
NOT qualities in a substrate; "that from which arises the origin of this"
(janmady asya yatah) is TATASTHA-LAKSANA, the accidental/relational definition
=> the Indian functional analogue of non-composition
RAMANUJA: an entity with no determinations is neither knowable, nameable nor worshippingable
=> Brahman must be qualified (savisesa)
MADHVA: VISESA, a real distinguisher inside a partless substance, lets Visnu possess
genuine attributes without composition – a third route between the first two.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/13: 6. Spinoza: God or Nature in the substance metaphysics (2022, 2024)

DEFINITIONS, FIRST

SUBSTANCE = what is in itself and conceived through itself

ATTRIBUTE = what the intellect perceives as constituting the essence of substance

MODE = a finite modification, in another and conceived through another

|

ONE-SUBSTANCE ARGUMENT

(1) substance is conceived through itself

(2) two substances cannot share an attribute

(3) an absolutely infinite substance excludes any rival substance

(4) therefore only God or Nature is substance; finite things are MODES

|

DEUS SIVE NATURA (Ethics; the phrase appears in Part IV Preface and Part I scholia)

infinitely many attributes; humans know THOUGHT and EXTENSION

a human mind is a finite mode under Thought; its body the corresponding mode under Extension

God is the IMMANENT, not the transitive, cause of all things

everything follows with necessity from the divine nature – no deliberation, no choice

|

FREEDOM REDEFINED: acting from the necessity of one's own nature, not choice among alternatives

RELIGION REDEFINED: the intellectual love of God = understanding the necessary whole

|

OBJECTION -> REPLY -> RESIDUE

personality, providence and free choice disappear -> freedom is self-determination

residue: petition, grace and moral address have no place

TRAPS: Spinoza is NOT a deist (no withdrawal, no creation-choice);

pantheism is NOT "God = the sum of physical bodies" (Thought is equally an attribute);

the 2024 stem asks how the notion is EMBEDDED – begin from substance, not from

the slogan "God is nature".

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/13: 7. Advaita: one Brahman, two standpoints, vivarta (2022 Q8(c))

NIRGUNA BRAHMAN (paramarthika, ultimate)

non-dual, self-revealing consciousness beyond LIMITING predicates

sat-cit-ananda as essential nature (svarupa-laksana), not three added properties

method: neti neti (Brhadaranyaka 2.3.6) | limit of speech: "whence words turn back"

(yato vaco nivartante, Taittiriya 2.9) | ineffability = failure of PREDICATION (avacya)

SAGUNA ISVARA (vyavaharika, transactional)

Brahman as related to maya: omniscient creator, sustainer, dissolver, moral governor,

legitimate object of worship – valid at its own level, sublated at the higher one

ARGUMENT: (1) changing objects are dependent and cannot be ultimate

(2) consciousness is presupposed by every known object

(3) Upanisadic instruction removes superimposed difference (adhyasa)

(4) atman is recognised as Brahman (Tat tvam asi, Chandogya 6.8.7)

WORLD: VIVARTA, apparent transformation – rope appears as snake; Brahman does not change

the world is empirically available and SUBLATABLE, not sheer nothing

TERMINOLOGY TRAP (examiner-visible): ANIRVACANIYA ("indeterminable", sad-asad-vilaksana)

is the status of MAYA and the world-appearance – NOT of nirguna Brahman, which is sat.

DOES ADVAITA LEAVE ROOM FOR THEISM? Yes, but PROVISIONALLY: devotion, scripture and divine

governance are empirically valid and purify the mind; final knowledge sublates the

worshipper/worshipped distinction. Sankara is neither straightforward theist nor atheist.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/13: 8. Visistadvaita: organic unity of God, selves, world (2020, 2022)

CIT (conscious selves) + ACIT (matter) are REAL qualifications, not appearances

SARIRA-SARIRI (body-and-self): a body is (i) wholly controlled by, (ii) wholly supported by, (iii) wholly for the purposes of its indwelling self (antaryamin)

=> world and selves are God's body; "body" states DEPENDENCE, not divine anatomy

APRTHAKSIDDHI: inseparability, NOT numerical identity – the jiva belongs to God and never becomes the whole of God

CAUSATION: God is BOTH material and efficient cause; world is real PARINAMA (transformation)

ARGUMENT: (1) scripture affirms unity and plurality

(2) the body-self relation preserves both

(3) the body is controlled by and exists for the indwelling self

(4) the cosmos is inseparably dependent without being illusory

RELIGIOUS PATH: knowledge -> disciplined action -> bhakti -> prapatti (surrender) -> grace
liberation = communion and service with retained individuality

OBJECTION -> REPLY -> RESIDUE

if the world is God's body, worldly defect infects God

-> the controller's perfection is distinct from the condition of the controlled body

-> divine consent (anumati) leaves moral authorship with the jiva

residue: responsibility for suffering remains a live pressure

CONTRASTS: vs Advaita – self is not Brahman but belongs to Brahman

vs Madhva – dependence is INTERNAL to one qualified whole, not five eternal differences.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/13: 9. Nyaya's God, parity bench, non-creator profiles (2021, 2019)

one | eternal | incorporeal | omniscient | never bound by karma

NIMITTA-KARANA: efficient and ordering cause; ETERNAL ATOMS remain the material cause

KARMADHYAKSA: supervises adrsta and allots fruits according to desert

later Nyaya: authoritative author of the Veda

FIREWALL: Udayana's inferences belong to Topic 02 Proofs

NON-CREATOR AND QUASI-THEISTIC PROFILES INSIDE INDIA

YOGA purusa-visesa: a special self untouched by affliction and karma; archetypal teacher; NOT the creator of nature's evolution

MIMAMSA eternal Veda, ritual order and unseen potency; no required divine author

SAMKHYA conscious selves + primordial nature as independent principles; no creator

BUDDHISM / JAINISM ... complete religious paths without an omnipotent creator

ADVAITA creator language belongs to the level of empirical dependence

CONTROL: "non-theistic" does not mean irreligious, atheistic in one sense, or morally empty.

"IS HINDUISM POLYTHEISTIC?" – criterion first: plurality of ULTIMATES vs of names/forms

RV 1.164.46 one existent, spoken of variously (Indra, Mitra, Varuna, Agni)

RV 10.129 (Nasadiya) origin resolved into "the One", ending in doubt

Brhadaranyaka 3.9 "three and three thousand" gods reduced to one

F. Max Muller supplied the terms henotheism / kathenotheism for the hymnic pattern

istadevata, avatara, trimurti subordinate plurality to one agency

Vaisnava / Saiva / Sakta each monotheistic in FORM; concede the genuinely plural practice

VERDICT: plurality of names, forms and access, not of ultimates; and the category itself is imported from the Abrahamic dispute – say so.

PARITY BENCH – pick ONE and finish it when the stem says "any one of the religions in India"

SAIVA SIDDHANTA pati - pasu - pasa; bonds = anava, karma, maya; Siva efficient cause, maya material cause; panca-krtiya (creation, maintenance, dissolution, concealment, grace); liberation = siva-tulya, LIKE Siva, never Siva

KASHMIR (PRATYABHIJNA) SAIVISM Siva = prakasa + vimarsa; world is real self-manifestation (abhasa) through sovereign freedom (svatantrya); liberation = RECOGNITION

-> sharpest contrast with Advaita: real expression vs apparent transformation

SAKTA Devi/Mahadevi supreme (Devi-Mahatmya, in the Markandeya Purana); Sakti is not an added attribute but the divine itself in dynamic aspect

MADHVA / DVAITA svatantra-paratantra; panca-bheda (five eternal differences);

bimba-pratibimba (reflection = dependence, NOT identity); taratamya (gradation).

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/13: 10. Comparative matrix and the manifestation test (2024 Q8(b))

SYSTEM	GOD-WORLD RELATION	GOD-HUMAN RELATION	MAIN PRESSURE
Classical theism	created, sustained, distinct	creature-creator, providence	evil; attribute coherence
Deism	created, then withdrawn	remote rational source	religious emptiness
Spinoza	identity: God = Nature	person is a finite mode	loss of personality
Advaita	vivarta, apparent	atman IS Brahman	world-status, devotion
Visistadvaita	real body (parinama)	distinct yet inseparable	embodiment and defect
Nyaya	ordered atoms, efficient	distinct soul, governed	is a governor necessary?
Saiva Siddhanta	maya as material cause	pati-pasu-pasa, grace	soul never becomes Siva
Madhva	eternally distinct, depend.	reflection, graded service	eternal gradation of souls

"MUST THE ULTIMATE CAUSE HAVE PHYSICAL MANIFESTATION?" – separate FOUR notions

- (i) descent/manifestation (avatara)
- (ii) embodiment
- (iii) material causation
- (iv) metaphysical dependence

ULTIMACY requires only (iv); a physical form would compromise non-dependence

classical theism and Advaita: NO physical manifestation required

Ramanuja: the world is God's "body" – dependence, not anthropomorphic form

pantheism: identity with nature, so the question changes shape rather than being answered

epistemic slide to watch: "we know causes through effects" is about KNOWING, not about BEING.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/13: 11. Examiner traps and the eighteen-point discipline

CATEGORY TRAPS

pantheism != panentheism (identity vs inclusion-with-excess)
monism != monotheism (plurality of reality vs plurality of deity)
henotheism != monotheism; monolatry != monotheism; kathenotheism = one-at-a-time supremacy
deism != atheism (a creator is affirmed; only intervention is withdrawn)
monotheism != classical theism (counting claim supplies no attribute package)

RELATION TRAPS

transcendence != spatial distance; immanence != physical inclusion or embodiment
Advaita's world != absolute non-existence (empirically available, sublatale)
aprthaksiddhi != identity; bimba-pratibimba != identity
Nyaya's God = efficient cause only; atoms are the material cause

TERMINOLOGY TRAPS

anirvacaniya belongs to maya/world-appearance, NOT to nirguna Brahman (avacya, neti neti)
simplicity is not "God is uncomplicated": it denies composition and has hard consequences
do not merge Saiva Siddhanta (dualistic) with Kashmir Saivism (non-dual)

METHOD TRAPS

do not list attributes without testing compossibility
do not answer a NATURE question with EXISTENCE proofs
do not "solve" foreknowledge by asserting timelessness: name the premise you deny
do not answer "Is Hinduism polytheistic?" yes/no: announce the criterion first
do not infer bodily form or male gender from personhood: predicates are analogical
do not expand process, finite or open-God concepts into a replacement syllabus.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/13: 12. PYQ routing and the directive decoder

2018 Q5(e) 10m Is Hinduism poly-theistic? -> Panel 9 + RV 1.164.46 / RV 10.129
2019 Q8(b) 15m personalistic and impersonalistic aspects -> Panels 2, 6, 7
2019 Q8(c) 15m man-God relation in ONE Indian religion -> Panel 9 parity bench (finish one)
2020 Q5(d) 10m free will and an omnipotent God -> Panel 4 (name the premise denied)
2020 Q7(a) 20m God in Hinduism, esp. Visistadvaita -> Panel 8
2021 Q5(a) 10m nature of God in Nyaya -> Panel 9 (profile, not proofs)
2022 Q5(a) 10m Spinoza's God and His attributes -> Panel 6
2022 Q6(b) 15m God and Self in Ramanujacarya -> Panel 8
2022 Q8(c) 15m Brahman in Advaita; room for theism? -> Panel 7
2023 Q5(a) 10m personalistic and impersonalistic aspects -> Panels 2, 6, 7
2023 Q6(b) 15m immanent AND transcendent in theism -> Panels 1, 2, 8
2024 Q6(b) 15m Spinoza's God in substance metaphysics -> Panel 6 (start from substance)
2024 Q8(b) 15m ultimate cause needs physical manifestation? -> Panel 10 (four notions)

DIRECTIVE DECODER

Elucidate clarify a DISTINCTION: two-column contrast + one reconciling device

Discuss balanced exposition PLUS a stated position

Critically examine reconstruct AND evaluate: doctrine -> presupposition -> objection -> verdict

Is there any compatibility ... yes/no thesis defended by naming the disputed premise

Do you agree ... give reasons explicit verdict, reasons ranked in descending strength

Write an essay on classify -> expound -> contrast -> assess

How is X embedded show the SYSTEMIC dependence first, then test it

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 13/13: 13. Answer spines and the qualified conclusion

ANSWER SPINES

- 10m: define the contrast -> one Western + one Indian formulation -> one discriminating distinction -> one objection -> verdict reusing the question's own term
- 15m: frame the attribute/relation problem -> doctrine + presupposition -> canonical example -> nearest rival -> objection and reply -> graded verdict
- 20m: classify the God-concept -> full metaphysical argument -> God-world and God-human relations -> Indian-Western comparison -> two objections with replies -> what notion of ultimacy survives

|

QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

"God" names a family of models – perfect person, infinite substance, non-dual consciousness, organic qualified unity, intelligent orderer, dynamic power. None is neutral, and each buys a religious or metaphysical good at a stated price: classical theism preserves worship and agency but carries the coherence burden; Spinoza secures unity and necessity but loses address; Advaita secures non-anthropomorphic ultimacy but makes devotion provisional; Visistadvaita secures devotion but must answer the defect objection; the non-creator profiles secure moral order and liberation without providence. Adequacy is judged by whether a model joins ULTIMACY, INTELLIGIBILITY, FREEDOM and RELIGIOUS LIFE without contradiction – and the examiner rewards the script that states which of these it is willing to trade.